# BCKMON

Backup monitor

# User guide

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# What it is and what you can do

**BCKMon** is a backup monitor. It gathers the state of all your backups on a single screen — NAS backups, backup programs that report by e-mail, file checks on a network drive and BCKMon's own backup — and warns you when one is missing, failing or too old.

BCKMon is the backup edition of PVEMon: both share the same code and the same server; only the look and the screens differ (BCKMon shows no nodes, machines or Docker).

- **One backup panel** with a traffic light, last successful backup, size and time left before the alarm.
- **Notices** by e-mail, Telegram, push notifications, webhook and Microsoft Teams.
- **Weekly summary** with the state of every backup.
- **Automatic backup of the application itself** to a folder, NAS or cloud.
- **Kiosks** to show the panel on a fixed screen.

# Signing in to BCKMon

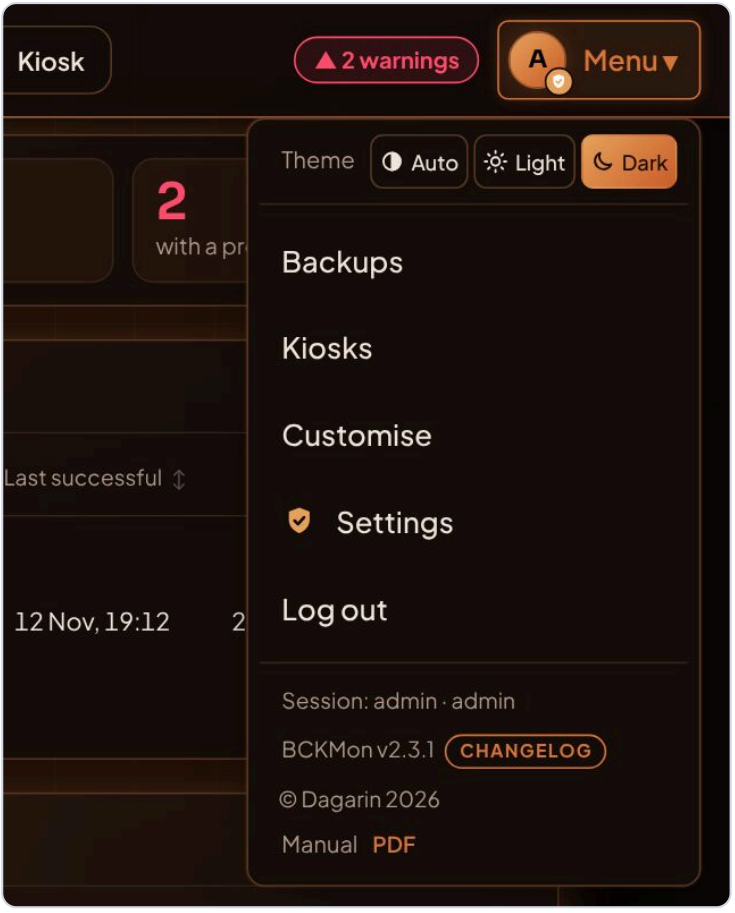
Open the address your administrator gave you, type your username and password and press **Sign in**. If your account has two-step verification (2FA) it will also ask for the code from your authenticator app. Below the form you can choose the language (Español / English).

> After 10 failed attempts in 15 minutes the account is locked for a while. If you forget your password, ask an administrator to reset it.

## Title bar and menu

The header has three areas: the name and icon on the left; **in the centre**, the navigation buttons; and on the right the alert badge (if any) and the **Menu** button.

- **Backups**: the panel with all your backups.
- **Kiosk**: opens a kiosk full screen (if you have several, you choose which).




The menu: theme, options, Log out, version and manual

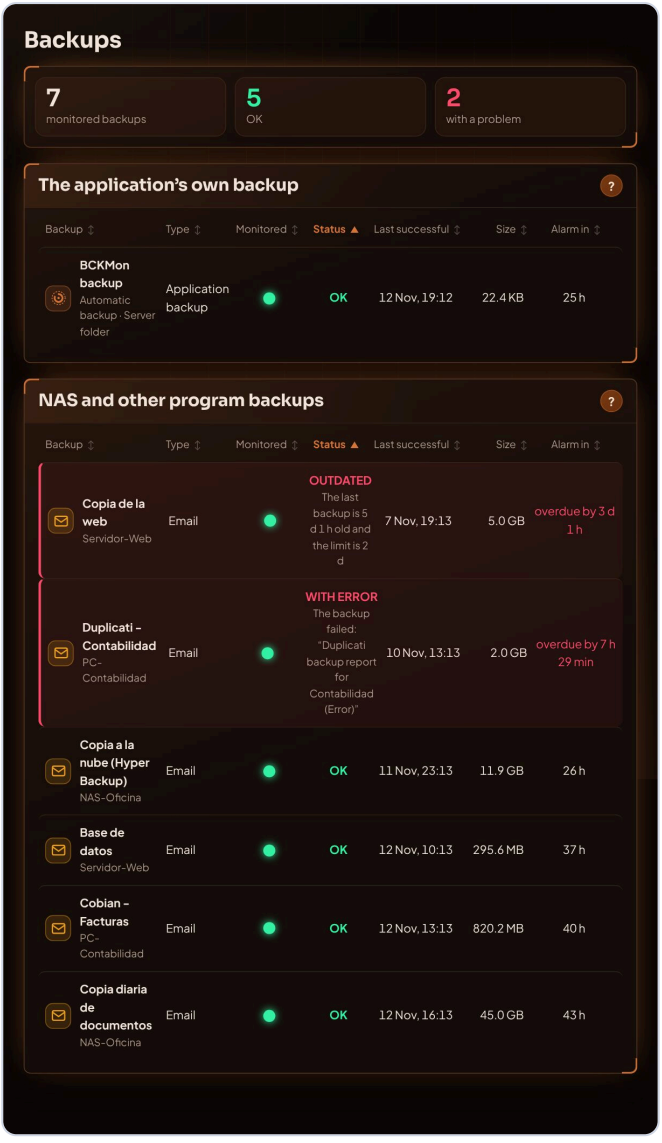
The **Menu** contains, from top to bottom:

- **Theme** (Auto, Light, Dark), on a single line, at the very top.
- The screens: **Backups, Kiosks, Customise** and, for administrators only, **Settings** (with the shield).
- **Log out**, right below the options.
- Your session, the version and the **ChangeLog** button (history of changes).
- **Manual · PDF**: downloads this guide in your language.

# Backups screen

This is the panel for all backups. At the top, the summary: **monitored, correct, with a problem** and, if any, **no data**. Below, one card per type of backup:

- **The application's own backup**: BCKMon's automatic backup (always first), with its state, date of the last successful backup, size and alarm.
- **NAS and other programs**: those arriving by e-mail (Synology Hyper Backup, Duplicati, Cobian...) and the file checks on a network drive.




Backups screen in BCKMon

| Column | What it shows |
|---|---|
| Backup | Name, source (machine or NAS) and an icon per type. |
| Type | E-mail, Proxmox, file on a network drive or application backup. |
| Monitored | Green dot: it is watched and warns. Red: it is not watched. |
| State | Correct, Error, Old or No data; with the reason if there is a problem. |
| Last successful | Date and time of the last good backup. |
| Size | How much that backup took. |
| Alarm in | Time left before the warning if no other good backup arrives («overdue» if already past). |

You can **sort** by any column by clicking its heading (on a phone, with the «Sort by» drop-down). Click a row to open its sheet: the state on top and, next to it, a **face with a counter** that changes face and colour as the alarm date approaches (and goes into crisis if the backup failed or the date has passed); below, last successful backup, size, last attempt and limit. The application-backup row takes you to its settings.




Backup sheet, with the face and the counter towards the alarm

> If a backup is red even though the last one was successful, read the reason: it usually means more time than allowed has passed without another backup.

## Alerts

When something needs attention the red button in the header counts the warnings and the **Alerts** screen lists them with their history. An alert fires when the condition lasts the configured time and resolves itself after a minute of stability.

You receive notices through the channels the administrator configured (e-mail, Telegram, push, webhook, Teams). In **Customise** you choose which ones you want for yourself.

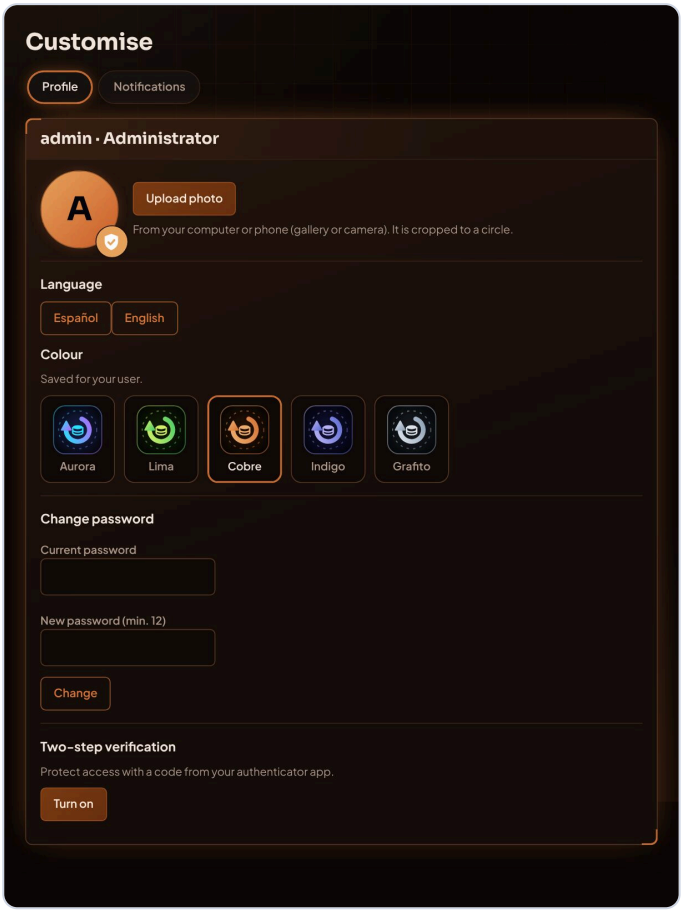
# Kiosk

A kiosk is a read-only screen meant for a TV or fixed monitor: it shows the panels you choose, with no menus, and can rotate between groups of panels. It opens with the **Kiosk** button in the header (full screen) and you leave it with the Esc key.

In **Kiosks** (menu) you create and edit your own with a canvas editor: you add panels (summaries, backup state, text), position and size them, and can undo and redo. You can have several kiosks and mark one as the main one.

# Customising your account

**Customise** gathers your own settings: your photo (cropped to a circle), your name, the language, the password change (asks for the current and the new one, minimum 12 characters), two-step verification (2FA, with an authenticator app and a QR code) and **My notices**, where you choose which channels to use.




Customise

# Installing BCKMon as an app

- **iPhone/iPad (Safari)**: Share → Add to Home Screen.
- **Android (Chrome)**: ⋮ menu → Install app.
- **Computer (Edge/Chrome)**: install icon in the address bar.

Once installed it receives push notifications with its own icon.

# Privacy and access limits

- BCKMon only **reads**; it changes nothing on your servers.
- A user with the **monitor** role only sees and receives notices about what the administrator marks as visible; they cannot enter Settings.
- BCKMon shows you no passwords, keys or internal addresses.
- Important actions are recorded in an administrator audit log.

# Administrators' appendix

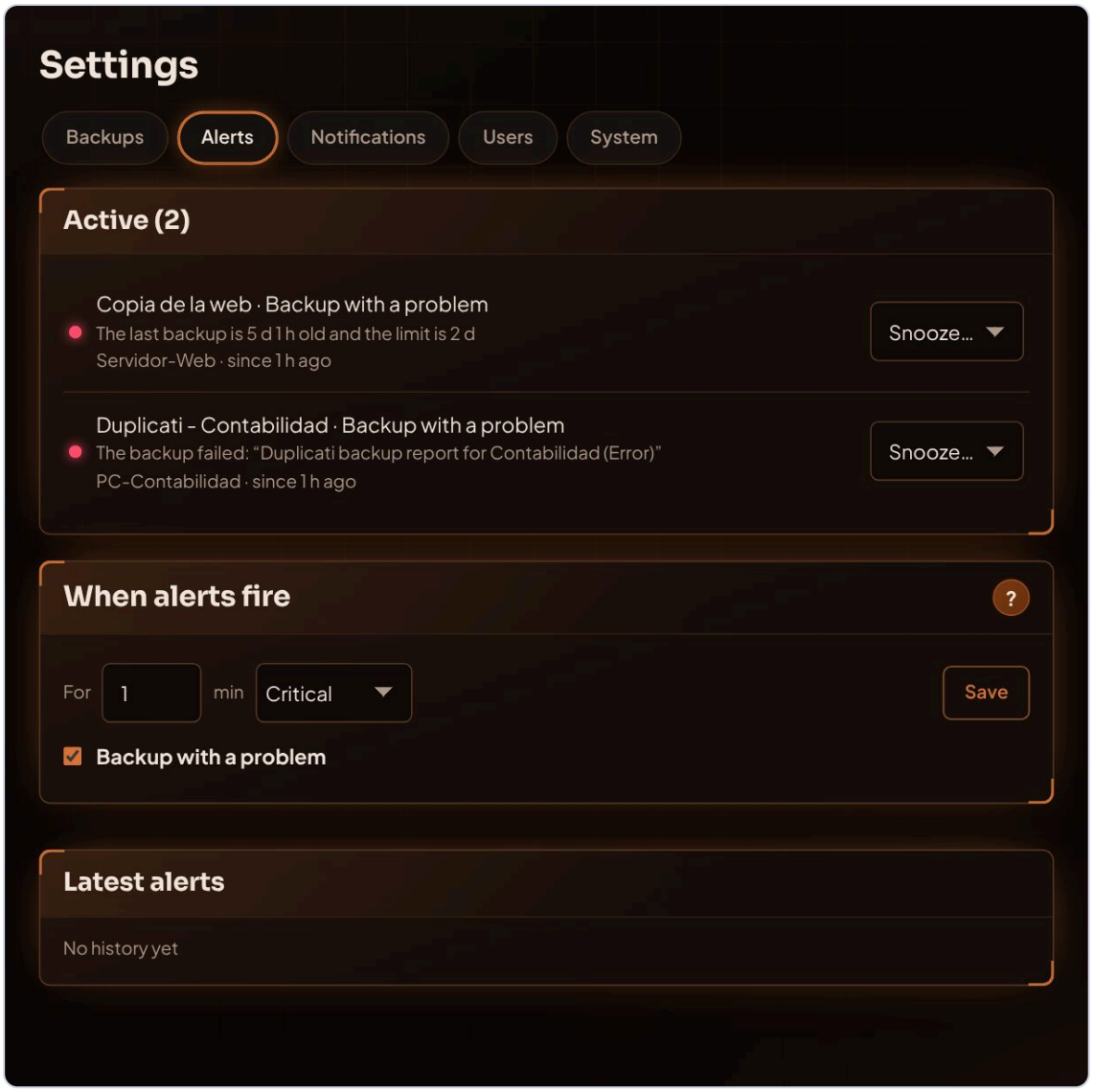
This part is only useful to whoever administers the application; a user with the monitor role does not see these screens.

# Settings (administrators)

**Settings** is divided into tabs. Some have second-level tabs of their own (for example Backups and System).

| Tab | What it is for |
|---|---|
| Backups › Copies | Backups by e-mail, by file on a network drive and by source; custom e-mail formats. |
| Alerts | Active and snoozed alerts, when the backup-problem warning fires, and the history. |
| Notifications | E-mail (SMTP), **weekly summary**, Telegram, webhook and Microsoft Teams. |
| Users | Accounts, roles, passwords, 2FA and each user's notices. |
| System | Export to PVEMon, external services (heartbeat and API) and BCKMon's backup to a destination. |

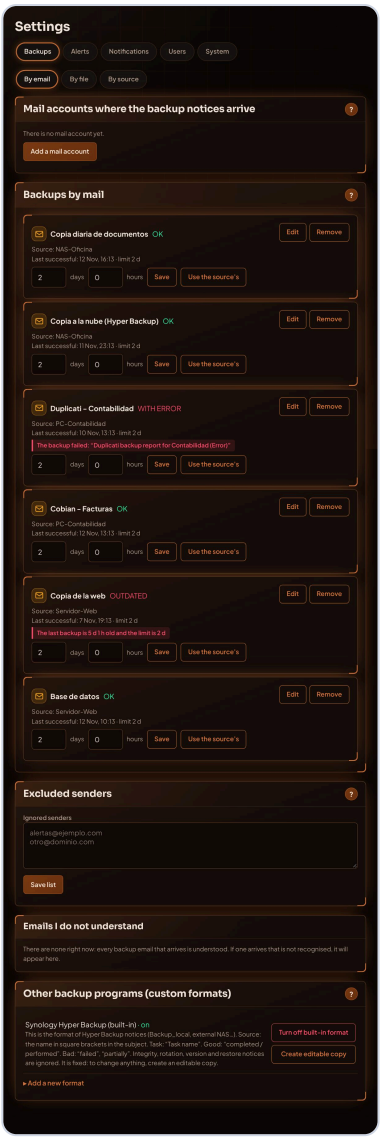
## Alerts




Settings › Alerts

A single card: the title on top; below, on one line, **«For [N] min [severity]»** with the **Save** button on the right; and under it the checkbox that enables or disables the «Backup with a problem» warning. Who receives the notice is chosen in Users → Notices.

## Backups: backups by e-mail and by file




Settings › Backups › Copies

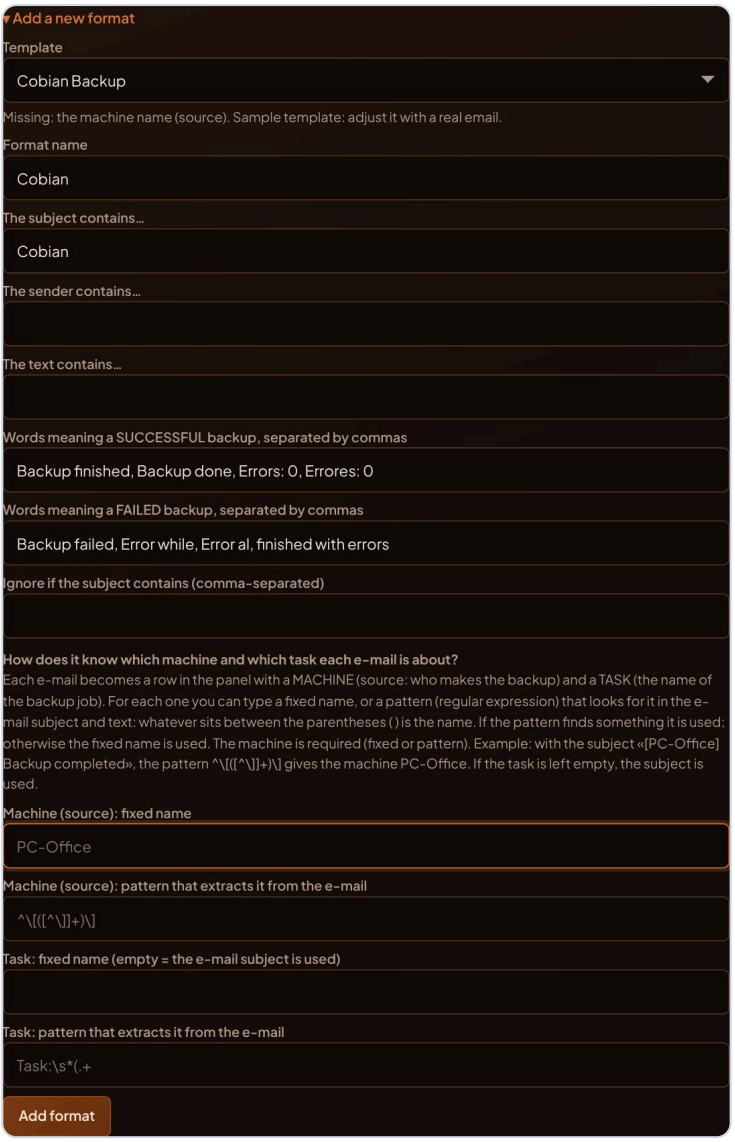
For programs that only report by e-mail (Synology Hyper Backup, Duplicati, Cobian, Proxmox…) you configure an **e-mail account (IMAP)** where the notices arrive; each backup is tied to a **source** (the machine or NAS) and you set how many days may pass without a successful backup. Senders already handled elsewhere can be excluded, and e-mails that are not understood are listed separately.

For what does not report, the **«Check a file or folder on a network drive»** check looks at the NAS directly over NFS: you pick the server, browse the exported folders, set the maximum age and minimum size, and it is checked every 5 minutes. PVEMon speaks NFS version 3 and only reads size and date.

## Custom e-mail formats: how templates work

If a backup program is not Synology, you have to tell PVEMon how to recognise its e-mails. In **«Add a new format»** you can start from a **template** (Duplicati, Cobian, Synology, Proxmox) or a blank one, and fill in:

- **When it belongs to this program**: the subject, sender or text contains a word (for example «Cobian»).
- **CORRECT / FAILED words**: separated by commas; if the e-mail contains any failure word the backup counts as failed.
- **Ignore if the subject contains**: for e-mails that are not backups (integrity notices, for example).



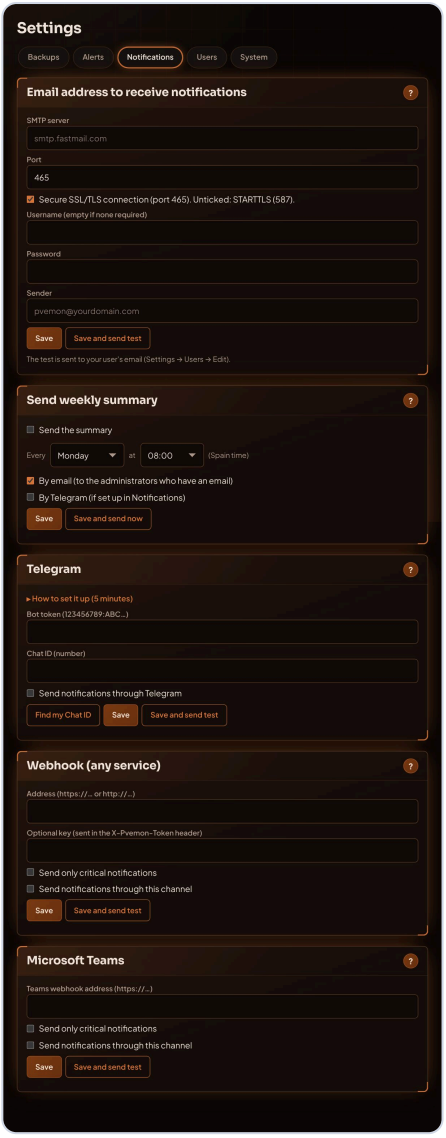

New format form, with the machine and task explanation

Each e-mail becomes a row in the panel with a **machine** (the source: who makes the backup) and a **task** (the name of the backup job). For each there are two fields:

| Field | When to use it | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Machine: fixed name | All e-mails of this format come from the same machine. | `PC-Office` |
| Machine: pattern | The machine name is inside the e-mail and changes. A **pattern** (regular expression) looks for it: whatever is **between the parentheses ( )** is the name. | `^\[([^\]]+)\]` extracts «NAS» from «[NAS] Backup completed» |
| Task: fixed name | One task for all e-mails. Empty = the subject is used. | `Proxmox backup` |
| Task: pattern | The task name appears in the e-mail. | `Task:\s*(.+)` extracts «Documents» from «Task: Documents» |

> If the pattern finds something it is used; otherwise the fixed name is used. The **machine is required** (fixed or pattern). Test the template with a real e-mail from your program before relying on it.

# Notifications

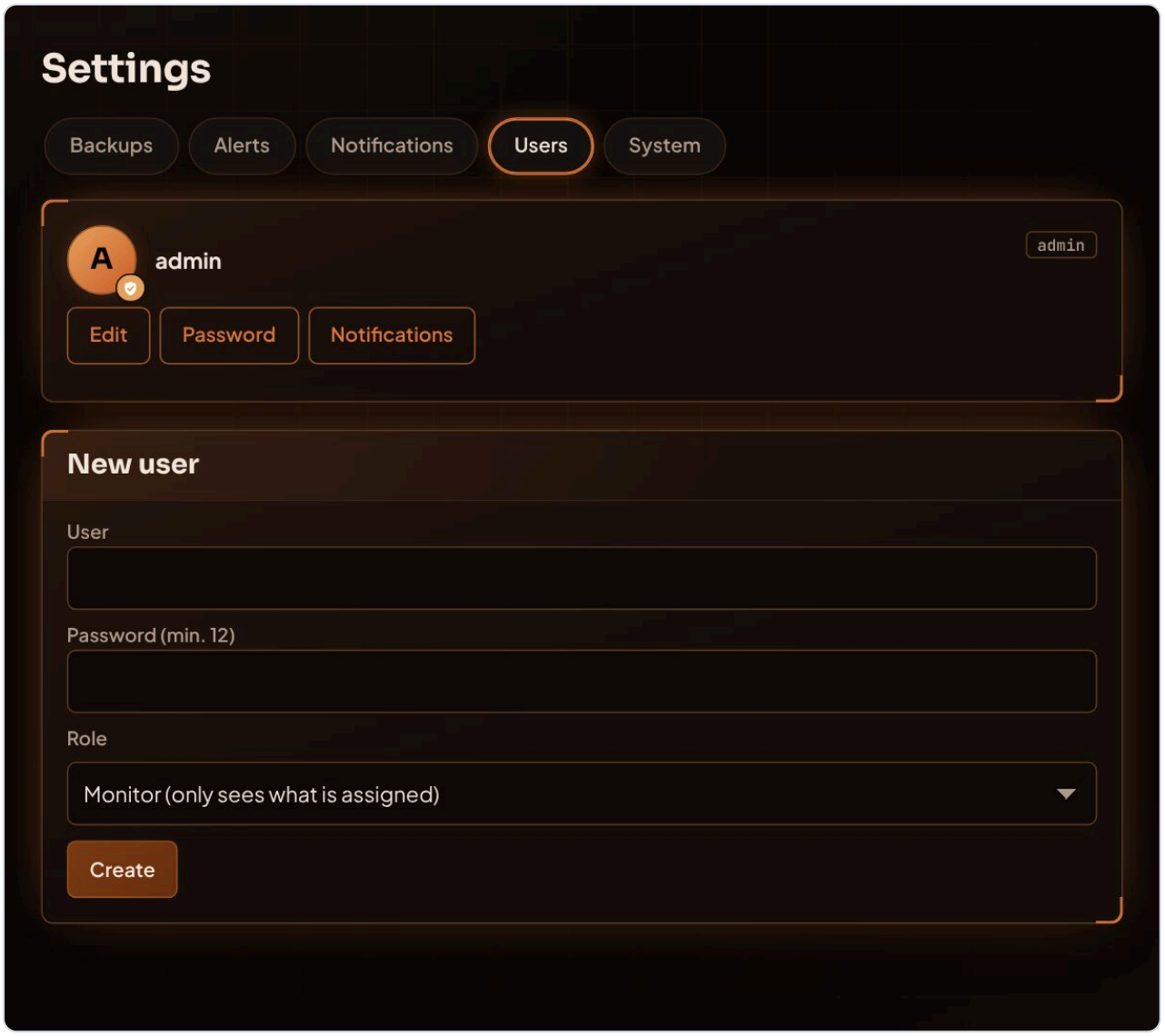



Settings › Notifications

On this tab, from top to bottom: the **e-mail (SMTP)** the notices are sent from; **Send weekly summary**; **Telegram** (bot and chat); a generic **webhook** (a JSON with the alert, with an optional key in the `X-Pvemon-Token` header) and **Microsoft Teams** (a Workflows flow webhook). Each channel has a test button and its addresses and keys are stored encrypted.

**Send weekly summary**: one message per week with the state of all backups (last successful, size, time to alarm), storage space and open alerts. You choose the day and hour, and whether it goes by e-mail (to administrators with an address) and/or Telegram. «Save and send now» tests it.

## Users



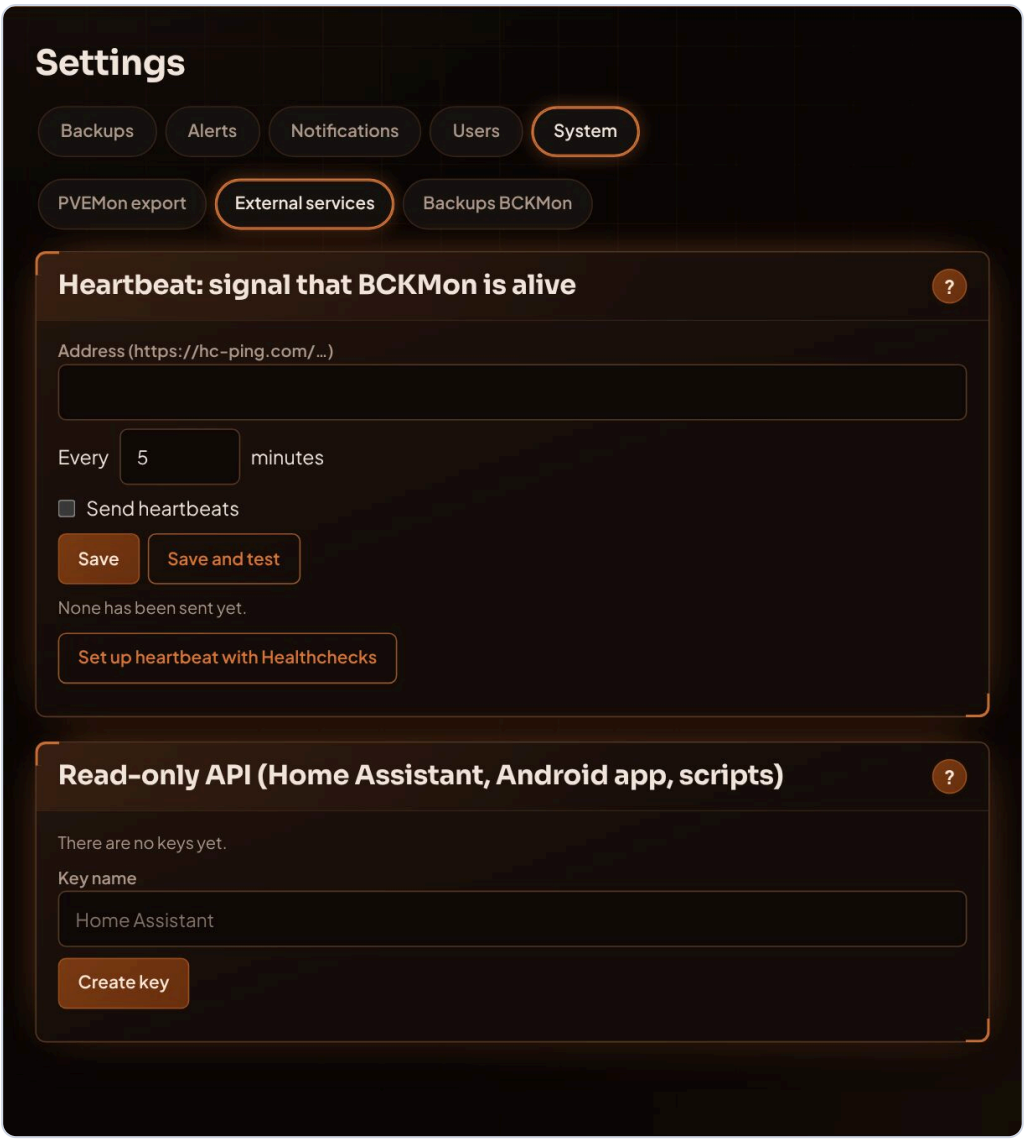

Settings › Users

Here you create accounts and choose their role (**administrator** or **monitor**). A monitor only sees and receives notices about what you mark as visible. The administrator can reset other users' passwords and 2FA.

## System

Three second-level tabs:

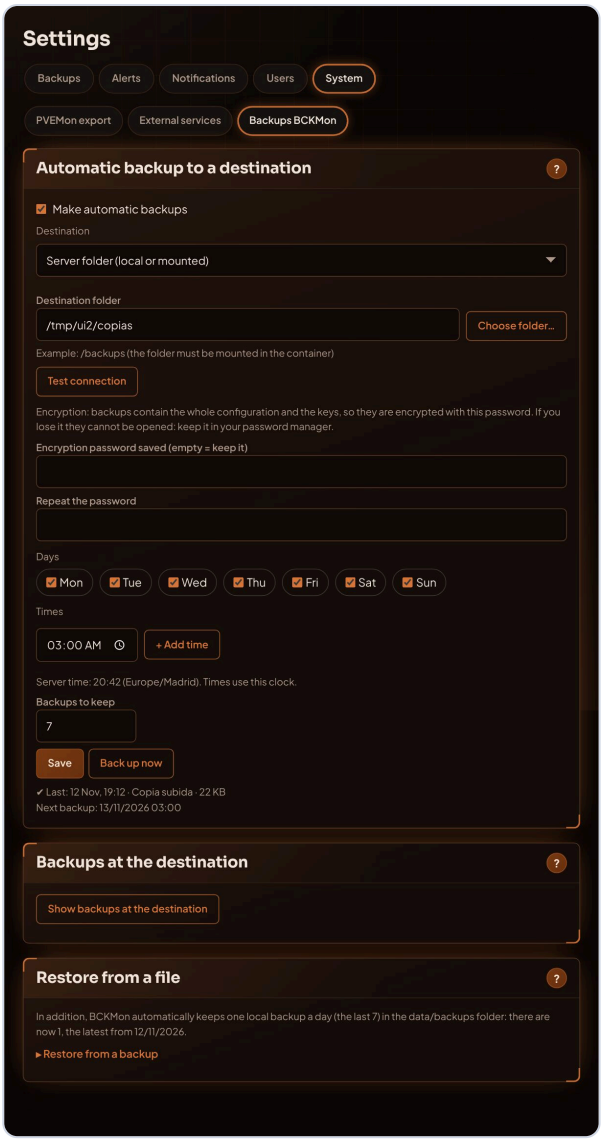
- **PVEMon export**: creates an encrypted file with only the backup configuration (sources, backups, e-mail, excluded senders and file checks; no users, kiosks or alerts) to import into PVEMon; and brings here what was exported from PVEMon, adding only what is missing.
- **External services**: the **heartbeat** (visits an address every N minutes — Healthchecks.io, Uptime Kuma, Home Assistant — so an outside service warns you if the application stops working) and the **read-only API** (keys for Home Assistant or scripts; shown once and unable to change anything).
- **BCKMon backups**: the automatic backup of the application itself (see below).




Settings › System › External services

## Automatic BCKMon backup to a destination

The **BCKMon backups** tab makes an encrypted copy of the configuration (users, settings, keys) and leaves it at the destination you choose, on the days and times you want, keeping the last N. The copy is encrypted with a **passphrase you choose** (minimum 8 characters): if you lose it the copy cannot be opened.




Settings › System › BCKMon backups

| Destination | What you need |
|---|---|
| Server folder | A folder (local or mounted) visible from the container, for example `/backups`. |
| NFS server | Server and exported folder (NFSv3) with write permission for the application's IP. |
| SMB/CIFS | Server, share, user and password. |
| SFTP | Server, user and password, and the folder. |
| Dropbox / Google Drive / OneDrive | It connects with an authorisation from the cloud itself (**Connect** button); your username and password are not stored. |

The **Test connection** and **Choose folder...** buttons check the destination before saving; **Copy now** makes a copy immediately and **Copies at the destination** lists those present and lets you **Restore**. Restoring replaces the current configuration, logs everybody out and restarts the application; it only works with the same secret key ( `SECRET_KEY` ) it was made with. The copy appears in the Backups panel, and an alert fires if a scheduled one is not made.

> Keep your `SECRET_KEY` and the backup passphrase in your password manager: without them a restore is not possible.

# Installing with Docker

BCKMon is published as a Docker image (`dagarines/bckmon`). A minimal `docker-compose.yml`:

```
services:
  bckmon:
    image: dagarines/bckmon:latest
    container_name: bckmon
    restart: unless-stopped
    ports: ["3000:3000"]
    environment:
      SECRET_KEY: "pon-aqui-una-clave-larga-y-aleatoria"
      TZ: Europe/Madrid
    volumes:
      - ./data:/app/data
      # - /ruta/de/copias:/backups   # destino de copias en una carpeta
```

1. Generate the key with `openssl rand -base64 32` and keep it: without it the data cannot be read and copies cannot be restored.
2. Start with `docker compose up -d` and open `http://server:3000`.
3. The first time it asks you to create the administrator user.
4. First configure Settings › Notifications (e-mail), then Settings › Backups (e-mail account and sources) and finally BCKMon's own backup in Settings › System.

## Recommended first steps

1. Add an **e-mail account (IMAP)** where your backup programs' notices arrive.
2. Create a **source** for every NAS or machine and set how many days may pass without a successful backup.
3. If a program is not Synology, add its **format** from a template (see «Custom e-mail formats»).
4. Set up **e-mail** and the **weekly summary** in Notifications.
5. Enable BCKMon's **automatic backup** to a folder, NAS or cloud.

## Export to PVEMon

If you also use PVEMon, the System › PVEMon export tab creates an encrypted file with the backup configuration to import into PVEMon (and brings in what you export from there). It carries no users, kiosks or alerts, and importing only adds what is missing.

# Security and resources

- Passwords with scrypt, optional 2FA and account lock after 10 failed attempts in 15 minutes (plus a per-IP limit).
- HttpOnly + SameSite=Strict session cookie (and Secure over HTTPS); it expires after 14 days.
- Request origin checks, security headers and generic errors.
- Keys, tokens and passwords stored encrypted with `SECRET_KEY`.
- Audit log of important actions.

### Recommendations

- Publish BCKMon only over HTTPS (for example with Nginx Proxy Manager) and close port 3000 to the rest of the network.
- Enable 2FA for all users.
- Keep `SECRET_KEY` and the `data` folder in your backups.

### Server resources

| Resource | Need |
|---|---|
| Processor | 1 core (almost no load) |
| Memory | ~180 MB idle; reserve 512 MB |
| Disk | Image ~400 MB plus the data |
| Network | In: port 3000. Out: e-mail, Telegram, push, webhooks, NFS/SMB/SFTP or backup clouds |

# Recent changes

The full history is under the **ChangeLog** button in the menu.

| Version | Change |
|---|---|
| 2.3.x | Settings cards with a title band; «Backups by mail» in its own card; backup sheet with a face and a counter towards the alarm; Theme first in the menu. Header with centred navigation; reordered menu (Log out after the options, Theme last on one line, manual link); weekly summary inside Notifications («Send weekly summary»); alerts in a single card; better-explained e-mail formats; application backup first in Backups; updated PDF guides and the first one for BCKMon. |
| 2.2.x | Automatic application backup to folder, NFS, SMB, SFTP, Dropbox, Google Drive and OneDrive; Settings reorganised with second-level tabs; the own backup shows in the Backups panel. |
| 2.0 – 2.1 | BCKMon edition (backups only), five colour palettes and a name per edition. |
| 1.5.x | Spanish and English; Docker image; PDF guide. |
| 1.x | First stable version, read-only API, multiple kiosks, disks, webhook and Teams, 2FA. |